



permanent spots in the senior team. Among India's Grade A players, only Harmanpreet stood out in the WPL. She unleashed early aggression with the bat, leaving bowling attacks without answers.

Fielding remains a concern, but the 2025 edition showed it's not just an India-specific issue. Young Indian players are now far more fearless in their approach — chasing balls, diving, and stopping crucial runs. Sree Charani's sharp fielding in the final, catches by Jemimah Rodrigues and Niki for DC, and G. Kamalini's boundary saves for MI are all encouraging signs.

This season also introduced fresh talent. Niki, who led India to its second consecutive Under-19 T20 World Cup title weeks before the WPL, impressed with the bat.

Kashvee showed immense potential and should be groomed as a like-for-like replacement for Pooja Vastrakar with her pace variations and batting utility. Bharti Fulmali's composed explosiveness nearly took the Giants to their first final.

"Building fast-bowling stock was an important early focus, and the WPL has identified multiple options (Kashvee, Kranti Goud, Saima) who can be developed for bigger roles in the national setup," Mithali added.

How the system nurtures these players will be critical, especially given India's inconsistent international planning.

Looking ahead to 2026, the league may expand to include additional teams and venues. With the caravan format tested, the BCCI is now evaluating the feasibility of a

Captain's knock: Harmanpreet Kaur led from the front with a crucial 66 off 44 balls in the WPL final, securing her second trophy as captain.

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home-and-away format for the WPL. With a dedicated annual window and an international player pool that thrives in India's high-energy atmosphere, the league has a promising future.

However, the WPL remains a toddler learning to walk, especially compared to the well-established WBBL, which integrates seamlessly into Australia's domestic cricket framework.

With the terrible twos and threes behind, it's time to look forward to the WPL's fantastic fours and fives!